



A PRIMER FOR PLAYERS AND DUNGEON MASTERS

The World of Elaria

Cosmology, Powers, and Places

The lore behind the chronicle: how the world is built, who threatens it, and what the Guardians are truly fighting for.



The lands of Elaria, and the road the Guardians walked: from Eldridge Vale in the west, over the Ravenstone Cliffs to wintry Havenmoor, then across the Open Sea to Wraithpine, Gearhaven, and the Old Shrine beyond.

The Shape of the World

There is not one world but many, turning side by side like the gears of a single great clock: the planes of Fire, Water, Air, Earth, and Shadow, and the Material world at their heart. For a thousand years the clock kept perfect time.

The planes do not spin on their own. They are held in place by anchor-stars, fixed points of light in the dark, each one cradling a plane in its orbit. While the stars burn, the worlds stay in their courses. When a star goes dark, its plane slips, and a crack opens between worlds.

Through those cracks leak Motes: bright drifting fragments of the planes themselves. Motes drive machines mad and wake strange creatures, the wondrous beasts the Guardians have met and befriended along their road. Gather the loose Motes, mend the cracks, and the world steadies again. That, in the simplest telling, is the work.

But a crack cannot be sealed from our side of it. Each fraying world keeps a guardian of its own, and the leaking corruption twists that guardian first; free the guardian, and that world's cracks close on their own. The heroes proved it in Gearhaven, when they freed the Grand Custodian and the city's wounds knit shut behind it.

The Star Map

As the Orrery of Planes shows it, plane by plane, anchor by anchor:

Fire, the plane Ignis: anchored to **Aldebaran**, flickering, and under attack.

Water, the plane Unda: anchored to **Fomalhaut**, flickering, and under attack.

Air, the plane Aer: anchored to **Vega**, going dark.

Earth, the plane Terra: anchored to **Antares**, two years dimming, and the first name in forty generations ever written back onto the list.

Shadow, the plane Umbra: anchored to **Algol**, dark.

Betelgeuse: the first star put out, the one Ash Catchum chased into the east.

Achernar: the reserve anchor, held back against the worst, anchoring nothing. The Circle keeps it lit and does not say why.

And one more, with no label. A dark star hangs on the Orrery that the Circle does not name, because nobody remembers its name, or the world it held. It was crossed off the list before the oldest living sky-reader was born. It is the reason the reserve exists.

◆ LORE OF ELARIA ◆ The Sky-Readers

The Circle of the Eternal Stars was founded by druids who noticed the stars did not wander like the wild things do. Somebody, they reasoned, must be holding them still. The Circle has watched the sky for forty generations, keeping lists of every star by name, which is why they were the first to notice when one of the names went dark.

Elaria, the Sleeping Warden

Elaria is not a goddess of war or harvest, but of balance: the Warden who once tended the lights of heaven and kept the planes in their courses. Long ago, in the War of Fractures, she led the gods against a devouring darkness and spent nearly all her power to seal it away. What

remained she bound into small safeguards and scattered, and then, diminished, she fell into a deep sleep.

She sleeps still, and because she sleeps the stars can be put out one by one. Who or what closed her eyes is a mystery not yet answered. She is not wholly gone, though: she guides those attuned to balance through visions and through gifts marked with her sign, a seven-pointed star wrapped in a leafed vine. When you see that star, she saw you coming.

The Shadow: Nyxthid and Maldrith

Two threats stand behind the failing world, one seen and one still hidden.

Nyxthid, the Harbinger of Decay, is the one the Guardians have glimpsed, and this is what they believe of him: a fallen celestial who once guarded the planes and now, twisted by despair, works to snuff the anchor-stars out. Nobody has seen his face. He deals in shadow, illusion, and fear, and he believes the kindest thing left is to let the whole clock wind down into dark.

Maldrith, the Weaver of Fractures, is the darkness Elaria sealed: an ancient, patient hunger from beyond the planes, pressing on the walls of every world, waiting for the last star to go dark. Nyxthid is only her herald. The old verses carry her name, and the heroes have heard it; what stays hidden is her nature, and how near she is.

The Covenant and the Relics

When Elaria spent her power, she bound what was left into safeguards and gifts, and some of these have found their way to the Guardians.

The Enchanted Potatoes, three of them, carried by Ursa and left by his father Ash: humble to the eye, but remnants of the shattered covenant, holding fragments of the goddess's own essence for the day they are needed.

The Essence Sphere, forged by the deep-gnome masters of Glimmerspire before the crisis ever began (how they knew is its own mystery): a gatherer of loose Motes, and the beating heart the world's great Rift Portal has always lacked.

The three relics of Wraithpine, each bearing the seven-pointed star: the Staff of Waking Constellations that relights a star with every victory, the Sash of the Swift Current, and the Pocket Dynamo. One chest, three gifts, one goddess guiding three chosen hands. Their full powers are set down in the compendium of treasures.



The three enchanted potatoes.



The three relics of Wraithpine.



The Essence Sphere.

A Gazetteer of Elaria

The chronicle's road runs west to east, village by village, and every stop on it has left a mark on the Guardians (and they on it). Here is each place as the chronicle knows it, followed by the roads not yet taken.

Eldridge Village and the Forest of Whispers

A quaint village in the rolling hills of **Eldridge Vale**, known for its bustling little marketplace, its seasonal festivals honoring Elaria, and the **Gilded Acorn Tavern**, the warm-hearted inn (Osric behind the bar, Rhea working the tables) where three young strangers first sat down at one table. Just beyond the fields waits the **Forest of Whispers**: ancient trees, hidden pathways, and a hush that is not quite silence, for the leaves seem to murmur with voices of the past.

Deep in the wood stand the mossy standing stones where the guardian **Duckleaf** kept its post, drawing power from the Plane of Air, and beyond them the **Grove of Elemental Waters**, where the party first saw motes drifting loose like sparks from a cracked lantern. The quiet pond where Lickgloom was befriended lies here too. It was in this forest that the work of the Guardians truly began.



Oakshade Village



gatherers came home dazed once the Mist Stalkers were dealt with, and Oakshade has counted the party as friends ever since.

A small village in **Oakshade Glade**, shaded by oaks so old the villagers name them like elders. Oakshade has always been a place of druids and rangers, folk who keep the surrounding forests and mark the turning seasons, and it serves as the waypoint for anyone traveling on to Ravenstone. The **Old Oak Tavern** (Alwen, proprietor) pours a famous mulled cider; Elder Merwin doubles as the blacksmith; Nina the herbalist knows every root and remedy in the glade.

The Guardians came here chasing rumors and found trouble worth the trip: Mudskips boiling up out of the wet fields, a Grimfang goblin ambush on the road, and the hulking Terranox shaking the earth itself. Merwin's missing herb-

The Whispering Glade

A ring of silver-barked trees off the Ravenstone road where the air goes still and starlight pools like water. Here, for the first time, **Elaria herself reached out**: a vision of the sleeping Warden, a warning of cracks between worlds, and a boon laid on each of the three travelers before the light let them go.

The glade is the closest thing the campaign has to holy ground. The Circle of the Eternal Stars whispers that places like it are thin spots in the world's cloth, where a sleeping goddess can press a hand through. Those who camp there report kind dreams and wake to find their small hurts mended.



Ravenstone Laboratory and the Ravenstone Cliffs

An impressive structure built straight into the **Ravenstone Cliffs**, high above a shimmering lake. This is the home of **Professor Aelwyn Ravenstone**, tall silver-haired high elf and the region's great scholar of planar phenomena, and his patient half-elf assistant Tamsin. Inside it is all alchemical apparatus, enchanted instruments, and shelves of research on the magical creatures of the region.

It was Aelwyn who first examined the Essence Sphere and pointed the party toward Gearhaven, and Aelwyn who offered them their first companion, three small creatures roaming his laboratory (they chose Floraburst, who would one day become Ghostbloom). **Lickgloom** lives at the laboratory still, taste-testing everything the Professor will allow and some things he will not.



The Road South: Brambleshadow, Ironroot, and Stormwatch

The long road from the cliffs down to the coast crosses wilder country: the tangled **Brambleshadow Thicket**, where a Shadowflame stalked the party through the thorns; **Whisperwind Meadow** and the fog-hung **Mistwood Path**; the stony **Ironroot Hills**, hunting ground of displacer beasts and the strange singing Shroomyte groves.

The road ends at **Stormwatch Cliffs**, where an old puzzle of standing stones guards the headland. There the Guardians saw him first: a **Dark Figure** wrapped in shadow, glimpsed in vision above a fractured world, holding a dying star in one hand. They did not know his name then. The chronicle does now, and it is written a few pages back.



Havenmoor

A wintry harbor town on the southern coast, all snow-dusted roofs, ships' bells, and chimney smoke. Its landmarks are dear to the party: the **Sugarplum Hearth** inn (Greta Frostbough's cocoa is a house rule unto itself), the **Frostwind Market Square**, the **Hollow Hearth Orphanage** kept by Sister Merida, Master Doran Bramblebeard's shipyard, and the **Wyrmgale Lighthouse** he tends on the point. A small **Shrine of Elaria** stands quiet at the town's edge, still unvisited.

Havenmoor is where the Guardians became heroes in the eyes of ordinary folk: when the **Krampusshade** stole the town's children, the party rang the eight Winter Bells, broke the three barriers, and sang the monster back into the dark. The lorekeeper Faelan sent them onward with three gifts that they carry to this day.





Havenmoor from the southern road: snow-dusted roofs, ships' bells, and chimney smoke over the harbor.

The Open Sea and the Flying Dutchman

East of Havenmoor the coast gives way to deep water, and the deep water kept a curse. The party sailed with Captain Brynn Wavewarden aboard the **Stormwind**, which the storm took to the bottom; from the wreck they were dragged aboard the **Flying Dutchman**, the ghost ship of **Davy Jones** himself.

Below its decks they found something worse than ghosts: a harvest operation, spectral essences packed in crates stamped with an Artificers' Guild seal, bound south for buyers unknown. Davy Jones was beaten at his own dice table and destroyed in his cabin, his crew freed, and the Dutchman finally allowed to sink. The Ghost essence Lilly drew from its hold began Floraburst's slow change into Ghostbloom. The sea is quiet now. The question of those crates is not.



Wraithpine and the Old Theater



The Gasping Gull on Wraithpine's cobbled square, where the lanterns stay lit on purpose.

A fog-bound village of carved pumpkins, swaying lanterns, and streets with names like **Pumpkin Row** and **Lantern Lane**, watched over by the belltower quarter called Bellshadow. The **Gasping Gull** inn (Maera, proprietor) sits on the cobbled square. Wraithpine looks like a festival that never ends, and for a while that was the kindest thing about it: a **False Hydra** nested beneath the **Old Theater**, singing the whole town into forgetting its missing neighbors.

The Guardians stuffed their ears with beeswax, followed the silence to the lair below the stage, and ended the song for good. In the quiet afterward they found the chest bearing Elaria's seven-pointed star: one chest, three relics, and a goddess's thanks. Wraithpine remembers everything now, and keeps its lanterns lit on purpose. The Old Theater stands empty on its hill, boarded and quiet; the town has not decided what to do with it, and the theater, for its part, is not telling.



Gearhaven, the Clockwork City



The eastern gate of Gearhaven, where every arriving traveler is wished steady gears.

The great city of inventors and the party's home base: brass towers, steam vents, tram lines, and Mechagnome citizens whose eyes flicker when the planes act up. Its heart is the **Artificer's Guild**, where Guildmaster Vane (the locksmith) and the silver archivist Quill keep ten years of impossible work: **Vane's Folly**, the Rift Portal, finished at last around the Essence Sphere. Beneath the Guild turns the **Great Governor**, the engine that makes the city's heartbeat, and above it the **Orrery of Planes** maps every anchor-star in the sky.

The chronicle's Gearhaven runs from the eastern gate and the Street of Small Wonders to Henna Brasspot's **Gilded Gear** tavern, Cogtooth Market, and down into the **Underworks**, where the party fought a rift swarm and rescued the goblin courier Skitch. In the **Verdant Plaza**, the city's one green place, they freed the corrupted **Grand Custodian** and laid it gently to rest, proving that a fraying world is saved by mercy, not by force. The city's wounds closed behind them.

◆ LORE OF ELARIA ◆ The Raising of Gearhaven

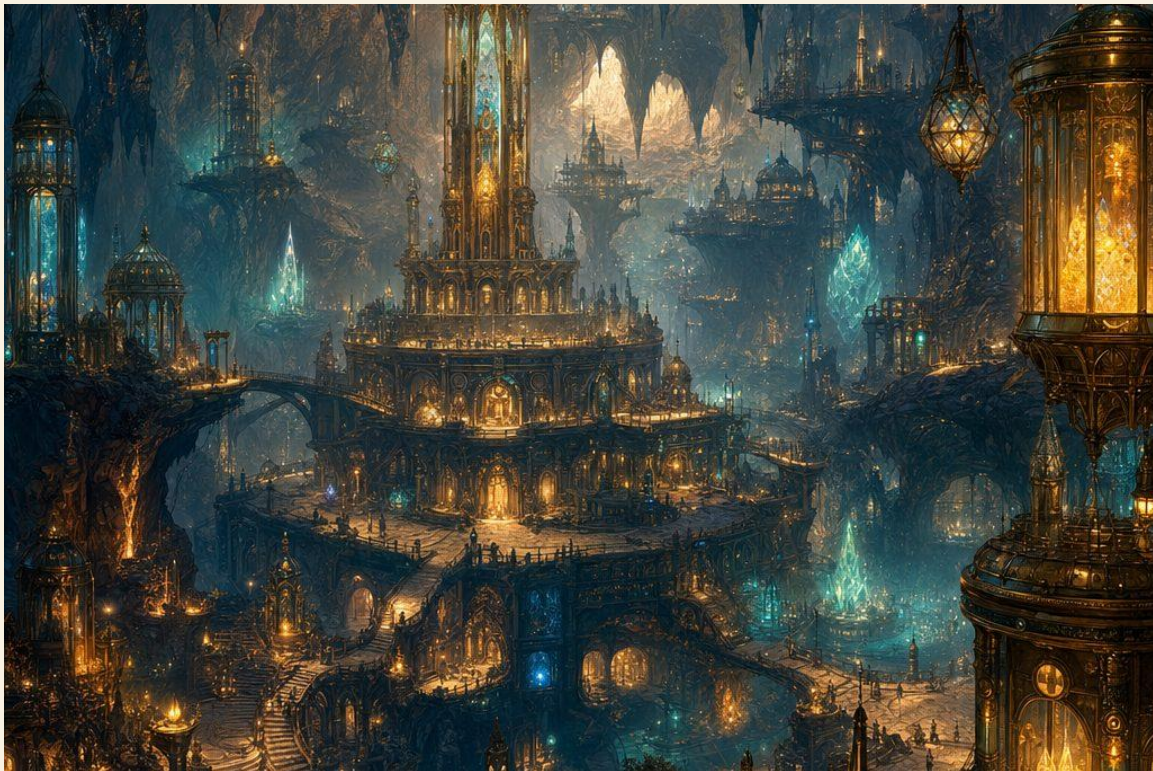
Gearhaven was not built on the mountain; it was built INTO a promise. The Mechagnome founders raised the Grand Custodian first, a gentle giant to hold the city's weight, and only then laid the first street. A city that begins with kindness to its largest citizen, the founders reasoned, will remember kindness to its smallest.

Roads Not Yet Taken

The map does not end at Gearhaven, and neither will the chronicle. These places are spoken of, dreamed of, or marked in old logbooks, and every one of them is waiting.

Bloodthorn Hollow, called simply the Hollow: the thorn-ringed home of the Bloodfang Clan, where Stabby was born. Word has come by way of the courier Skitch that cracks are opening near the Hollow and the clan blames the artificers. Someone will have to go home and set that right.

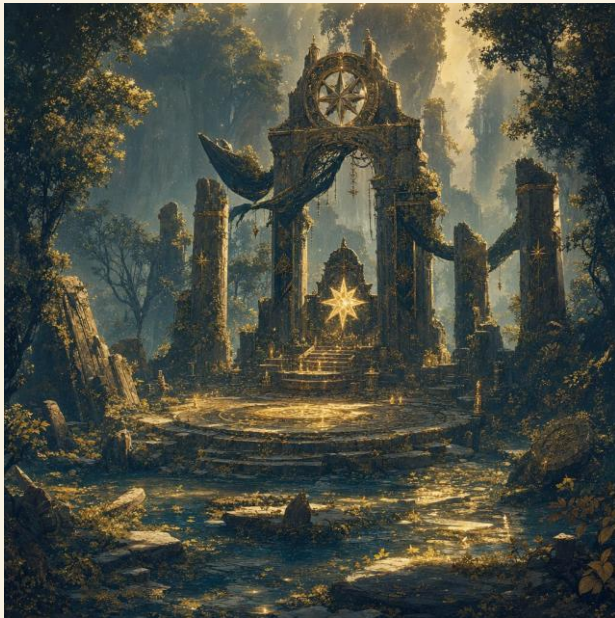
Glimmerspire and Deepforge Hollow, far below in the Underdark: the deep-gnome city of forges and the academy where Lilly built her first turret, home of her mother Poots and Master Crafter Drown Sparkwick. Glimmerspire forged the Essence Sphere before the crisis ever began. How they knew it would be needed is a question with a long answer.



Glimmerspire, the deep-gnome city of forges in the Underdark, where the Essence Sphere was made before anyone knew why.

◆ LORE OF ELARIA ◆ The Delvers

The deep gnomes say they were born of the world's own curiosity: stone that wanted to know what stone was. They delved not for gold but for questions, and Deepforge Hollow sits at the bottom of the longest question anyone ever asked.



often. No Guardian has yet set foot inside.

The five rift-worlds beyond the portal: Terra the earth-plane first, under dimming Antares, then Unda, Ignis, Aer, and last of all Umbra, the plane of Shadow, under a star already dark. Each failing world keeps a corrupted guardian of its own, and each guardian is waiting, whether it knows it or not, to be freed.

◆ LORE OF ELARIA ◆ **The Rift Portal**

The Old Shrine in the east: Ash Catchum's last logbook entry reads, "The pattern leads east. Following the dark. To the old shrine." The Circle's elders believe he meant the **Ancient Shrine of the Forgotten Glade**, a hidden temple of Elaria deep in old-growth wood, said to hold secrets of the covenant and of the enchanted potatoes themselves. Ursa's road bends that way, sooner or later.

The Crystal Cavern of Crystal Hollow: deep within the Ravenstone Cliffs, a cavern of luminescent crystals glowing in every color, said to house creatures tied to the elemental forces. Professor Aelwyn's notes mention it



Doors between worlds are older than the Darkening; the Weaving was full of them, all closed politely behind the movers when the furniture of creation was arranged. What Guildmaster Vane built in Gearhaven is not a new idea. It is a very old door, rebuilt from memory, waiting for a key shaped like a heart.

Why the gazetteer matters: the sky is going out, one anchor-star at a time, and the Rift Portal stands open at last. Every road on these pages leads, in the end, to a star: one to relight, one to guard, or one to follow east into the dark. Wherever the Guardians go next, they have already walked the first half of the map.